

FACT FILE

Deinonychus

With its large, sharp claws and teeth, Deinonychus was a Cretaceous killer. This theropod dinosaur could run at high speeds and do a lot of damage with its weaponry. It is one of the dinosaurs most closely related to modern birds.

» **Length:** 10 ft (3 m)

» **Weight:** 175 lb (80 kg)

» **Diet:** Meat

» **Habitat:** Woodland



Two clawed feet were used for walking.

Sharp talons could rip flesh.



The small head crest may have been for display.

Feathers covered Deinonychus.

Distant relatives

You may not expect to see birds on a dinosaur's family tree, but they are their closest living relatives. In fact, birds are dinosaurs! During the Jurassic period, some meat-eating theropod dinosaurs developed into feathered fliers and although many of these birds died out in the mass extinction, some survived and have been flying high ever since.

Chickens have dense feathers, which keep them warm and protect their skin.